

	EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES AGENCY	POLICY NUMBER	722
	A Division of the Merced County Department of Public Health	Effective Date	11/2025
Authority: Health and Safety Code, Division 2.5, and California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 9, Chapter 4, 1797.220		Initial Date:	05/2018
		Review Date:	01/2028

STROKE
A sudden onset of symptoms is defined as six (6) hours or less. Characterized by a sudden onset of: - Weakness or paralysis on one side of the body or face - Slurred speech or speech difficulty - Issues maintaining balance - Headache or visual disturbances (blindness, fixed lateral gaze, etc.)
ADULT
BLS
Focus on the onset of symptoms. Assess Vitals / Obtain SpO ₂ / Oxygen - Titrate to SpO ₂ of 94% or higher / Secure Airway - Assist Ventilations if needed. Blood Sugar Check - For patients who have ALOC.
ALS
Follow BLS procedures if applicable. Obtain 4-Lead ECG. Vascular Access - IV/IO rate as appropriate.
Cincinnati Prehospital Stroke Scale
Facial Droop - Ask the patient to smile and show their teeth - Normal: Both sides of the face move equally - Abnormal: One side of the face does not move as well as the other Arm Drift - Ask the patient to close their eyes and hold up both arms for 10 seconds - Normal: Both arms move up the same or both arms do not move at all - Abnormal: One arm does not move, or one arm drifts down compared to the other Speech - Ask the patient to repeat a simple phrase, such as, "You can't teach an old dog new tricks." - Normal: The patient says the correct words with no slurring of speech - Abnormal: The patient slurs words, says the wrong words, or is unable to speak

Signatures on File

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